

THE CONCIERGES AT India's newest luxury hotels are fielding an unusual request these days—not reservations at a Michelin-star restaurant or a helicopter ride over the Himalayas, but an audience with a spiritual master, a private Ganga *aarti*, a Vedic astrologer, or meditation at dawn overlooking the sacred river.

India's luxury hospitality industry has stumbled upon its most unexpected growth segment: the *moksha* economy or the business of inner liberation, a convergence of hospitality, wellness, heritage and spirituality that is reshaping investment strategies. This growth is driven by affluent travellers who are increasingly seeking experiences that promise emotional renewal, cultural immersion, and spiritual discovery.

"Luxury, once measured by thread count and square footage, is being redefined by rituals and mindfulness. Hotels are no longer merely selling rooms with scenic views; they are curating journeys through India's civilisational heritage. Private temple rituals, bespoke pilgrimages, Ayurvedic therapies, Vedic consultations and encounters with local traditions have become premium offerings commanding both higher room rates and longer guest stays," says Neena Kukreja, a Mumbai-based travel curator.

The proposition is compelling because India possesses

